Phase 2: **User Research**

Step 1 1
User InterviewsP + Surveys 1
Step 2 **4**
SWOT Analysis 4
Strengths 4
Weakness 6
Opportunities 8
Threats 10
Step 3 **10**
Goal setting - Linking User Pain to Business Impact 10
Step 4 **11**
Personas - Bringing Users to Life 11
Persona 1: The Research-Driven Student 11
Persona 2: The Insight-Seeking Product Manager 12
Step 5 **13**
Problem Prioritization - Choosing P0 13
Problems identified 13
Score with PIF (Population × Intensity × Frequency) 13
Strategic filters 13
Product strength 14
Scope 14
P0 problem 14
Problem Statement 14

Step 1

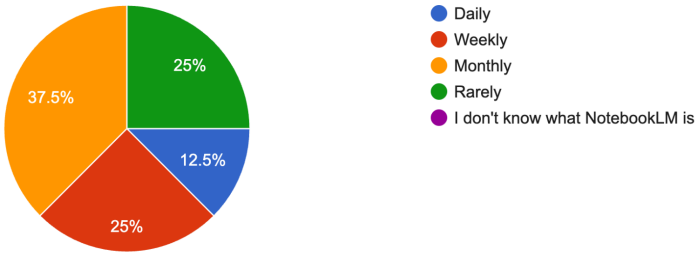
User Interviews + Surveys

Based on insights from **user interviews and survey responses** across polls and groups, several clear themes emerged.

S. No	Theme	What users asked for	User problem observed	Impact
1	Personalized AI Responses	More relevant outputs, tailored summaries, better formatting	AI responses often don't match the user's research goal, requiring prompt refinement.	Lower satisfaction and increased switching to other AI tools.
2	AI Response Quality	More accurate summaries, stronger reasoning, reliable citations	Generic or incomplete responses reduce trust in AI-generated insights.	Lower retention and reduced product usage.
3	Research Workflow	Better organization, customizable outputs, export options	Users leave NotebookLM to finish research in external tools.	Lower engagement and lower feature adoption

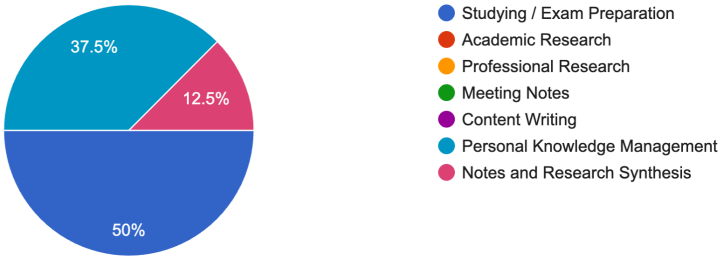
How often do you use NotebookLM?

8 responses



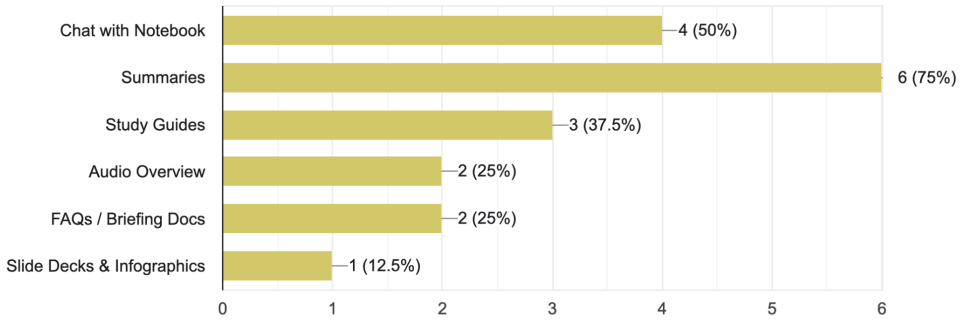
What do you primarily use NotebookLM for?

8 responses



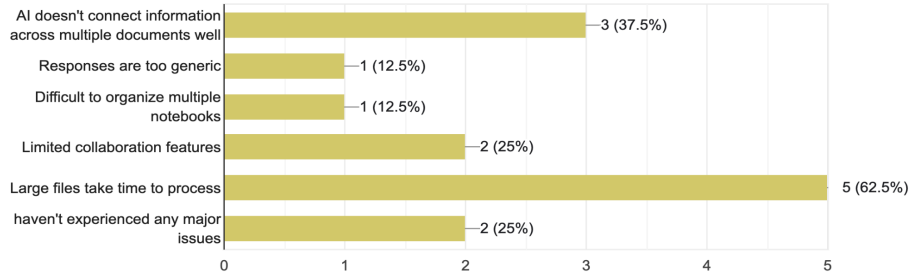
Which NotebookLM feature do you use the most?

8 responses



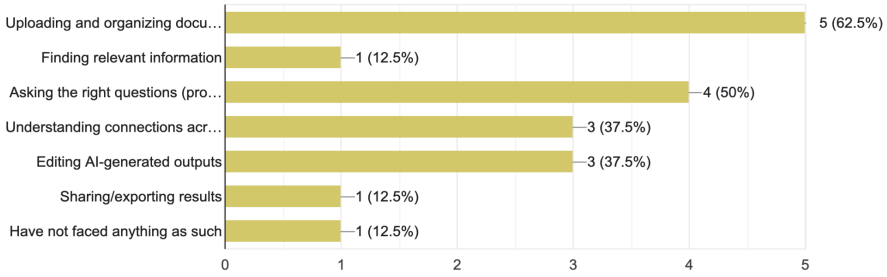
Which challenges have you experienced while using NotebookLM?

8 responses



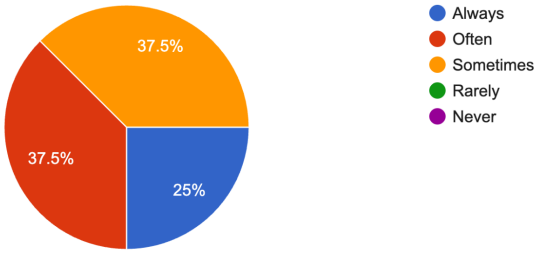
Which part of your NotebookLM workflow takes the most effort?

8 responses



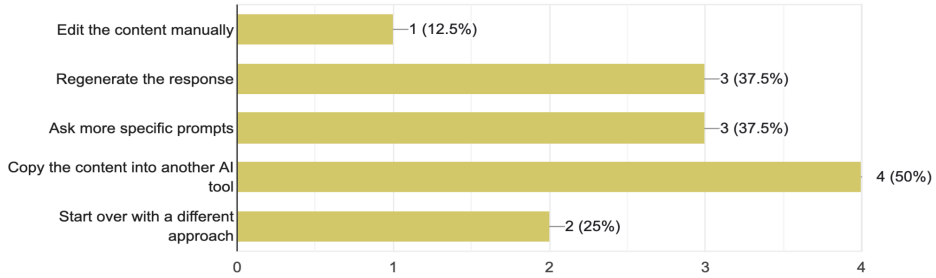
How often do you work with multiple documents in a single Notebook?

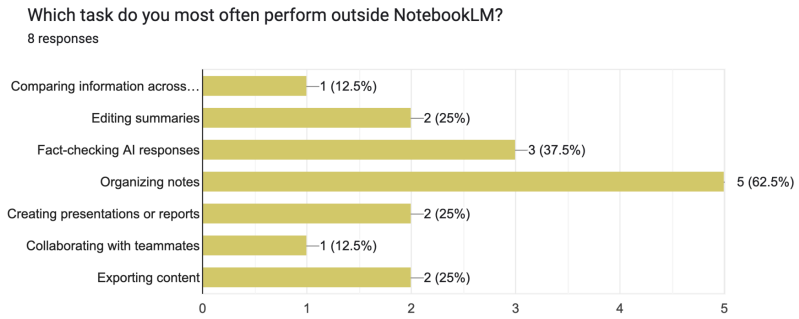
8 responses

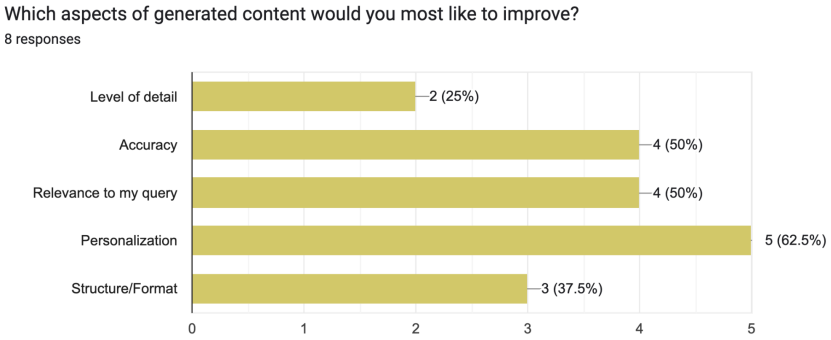


When NotebookLM's generated content isn't satisfactory, what is your usual next step?

8 responses







Step 2

SWOT Analysis

Based on recurring themes in App Store reviews, community discussions, and the current product capabilities, here's a SWOT analysis of user feedback in Google Play store and App store.

Strengths

- Audio Overviews and study tools (summaries, notes, quizzes) are highly appreciated by students.
- Clean interface and simple workflow make research easy.
- Excellent for learning from personal documents instead of generic web knowledge.

Weaknesses

- AI responses can be generic and not aligned with different research objectives.
- Limited personalization based on user intent.
- Users often refine prompts multiple times before getting useful outputs.

Opportunities

- Introduce intent-aware AI that adapts responses based on research goals.
- Offer multiple research modes (Study, Compare, Report, Brainstorm, Deep Research).
- Improve personalization while maintaining source-grounded answers.

Threats

- AI capabilities are quickly becoming commoditized across competing products.
- Users may prefer all-in-one productivity platforms such as Notion AI or Microsoft Copilot.
- High user expectations mean missing or delayed features can reduce satisfaction despite strong ratings.

Step 3

Goal setting - Linking User Pain to Business Impact

S. No	User Problem	Leads to User behaviour	Business Impact / Metric affected
1	AI responses don't match research intent	Users repeatedly refine prompts	• Low engagement • Low retention
2	Generic AI-generated outputs	Users regenerate answers or rewrite content manually	• Low task completion
3	Unsatisfactory responses	Users switch to ChatGPT, Claude, or Gemini	• Low retention
4	Limited personalization	Users spend extra time editing AI outputs	• Low satisfaction
5	Research workflow isn't optimized	Users rely on external productivity tools	• Low feature adoption • Low retention

Chosen primary metric: **Retention** because

- Reflects whether users find NotebookLM valuable enough to return regularly.
- Indicates adoption as part of users' ongoing research and learning workflow.
- Signals long-term product value and sustainable user engagement.

Goal statement: *Increase user retention by delivering relevant and personalized research outputs that reduce prompt refinement and minimize switching to external AI tools.*

Step 4

Personas - Bringing Users to Life

Persona 1: The Research-Driven Student

Identity	• Name: Rakshith • Role: Master's Student • Age: 26 • Location: Bengaluru • Tagline: "I want to spend more time learning than organizing notes."
Goals	• Understand complex topics quickly. • Generate concise summaries and study guides. • Find answers across multiple lecture notes and research papers.
Behaviours	• Uploads lecture notes, PDFs, and research papers. • Uses NotebookLM before exams and assignments. • Frequently asks follow-up questions to clarify concepts. • Revisits notebooks throughout the semester.
Frustrations	• Study guides feel too generic. • Difficult to organize multiple notebooks for different subjects. • AI responses often don't explain concepts in the way I need, so I keep rewriting prompts.

Quote	"I don't want to keep rewriting prompts—I want NotebookLM to understand what I'm trying to learn."

Persona 2: The Insight-Seeking Product Manager

Identity	• Name: Alisha • Role: PM • Age: 30 • Location: Hyderabad • Tagline: “Help me turn information into decisions.”
Goals	• Synthesize insights from PRDs, research reports, and meeting notes. • Quickly prepare briefs and presentations. • Reduce time spent searching across documents.
Behaviours	• Uploads PRDs, customer feedback, competitor reports, and meeting notes. • Uses NotebookLM several times a week for product discovery. • Generates summaries before stakeholder meetings. • Cross-checks AI responses with source citations.
Frustrations	• AI responses don't always match the type of output I need, whether it's a report, comparison, or brainstorming session. • Limited control over the format and depth of generated outputs. • Difficult to manage a growing collection of notebooks.
Quote	"Understand what I'm trying to accomplish—not just what I'm asking."

Step 5

Problem Prioritization - Choosing P0

Problems identified

1. Difficulty organizing multiple notebooks and sources.
2. AI misses insights across multiple documents.
3. AI-generated outputs are too generic.
4. Limited collaboration and sharing.
5. Limited customization of study materials.

Score with PIF (Population × Intensity × Frequency)

Problem	Population	Intensity	Frequency	PIF score
AI-generated outputs are too generic	5	5	4	14
Difficulty organizing multiple notebooks and sources	4	4	4	12
AI misses cross-document insights	4	4	3	11
Limited collaboration and sharing	3	3	3	9
Limited customization of study materials	3	3	3	9

Strategic filters

Users are more likely to return when NotebookLM consistently generates responses that match their research objective with minimal prompt refinement.

Product strength

★ Source-grounded AI
★ Personalized AI responses
★ Research assistance
★ Reliable citations
★ Intent-aware content generation

Scope

Improve how NotebookLM understands user intent and adapts AI-generated responses without changing its core research workflow.

P0 problem

Users struggle to get relevant and personalized research outputs from NotebookLM, leading them to repeatedly refine prompts or switch to other AI tools.

Because

- Strongly supported by survey findings.
- Directly impacts user satisfaction and retention.
- Affects the core AI experience across all user personas.
- Aligns with NotebookLM's goal of becoming a trusted research assistant.

Problem Statement

Users struggle to get relevant and personalized research outputs because NotebookLM doesn't consistently understand their research intent. As a result, they repeatedly refine prompts, manually edit responses, or switch to other AI tools to complete their work.